

Connor Douglas

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44 W 4th St., KMC 8-180, New York, NY 10012 | U.S. Citizen

Bio

My research interests broadly lie at the intersection of machine learning and economics. I am interested in the design and evaluation of data-driven decision-making systems, where I aim to make methodological contributions in adaptive experimentation and causal inference. I am grateful to be supported by the NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Program (GRFP) and NYU Stern doctoral program.

Interests: *machine learning, experimentation, personalization, markets, multi-agent systems, causal inference*

EDUCATION

New York University, Stern School of Business <i>Ph.D. Information Systems — Technology, Operations, & Statistics department</i> <i>Committee:</i> Foster Provost (chair), João Sedoc, Arun Sundararajan, Sean Taylor, Zhengyuan Zhou <i>GPA: 3.93/4</i>	2022 - Present New York, NY
Washington University in St. Louis <i>B.S. Computer Science & Economics — McKelvey School of Engineering</i> <i>Advisor: Yevgeniy Vorobeychik</i> <i>Summa Cum Laude (GPA: 3.98/4)</i>	2018 - 2022 St. Louis, MO

PROFESSIONAL RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Spotify (Incoming) <i>Research Scientist Intern</i> <i>Personalization Economics Team</i>	Jun. 2026 – Sept. 2026 New York, NY
United Nations <i>Data Science Research Intern</i> <i>Adressing digital mis/disinformation</i> Studied methods for identifying mis/disinformation relevant to UN peacekeeping Constructed novel method of detecting coordinated behavior through semantic similarity of social media content Built social media monitoring tool to track narratives circulating on social media channels Designed sampling methods for adaptive learning of sentence embedding models	Nov. 2023 – May 2024 New York, NY
Genentech <i>Software Engineering Intern</i> Developed novel technique for creating structured data from unstructured clinical trial protocols Led project in developing full-stack clinical study management tool Designed and built front-end of question-answering tool ingesting protocol documents	May 2020 - May 2021 South San Francisco, CA

PUBLICATIONS

<i>PRISM: LLM-Guided Semantic Clustering for High-Precision Topics</i> Connor Douglas, Utkucan Balci, Joseph Ayelett-Bullock <i>Forthcoming, Proceedings of the ACMWeb Conf. WWW. 2026.</i>	
<i>Naive Algorithmic Collusion: When Do Bandit Learners Cooperate and When Do They Compete?</i> Connor Douglas, Foster Provost, Arun Sundararajan <i>Proceedings of the International Conference on Information Systems. 2024.</i>	
<i>Computing an Optimal Strategy in a Baseball At-bat</i> Connor Douglas, Everett Witt, Mia Bendy, Yevgeniy Vorobeychik <i>Proceedings of FLAIRS-36 Conference. 2023.</i>	
<i>Techniques for Abstraction of Unstructured Clinical Trial Health Data</i> Lukas Corey*, Jennifer Crawford*, Connor Douglas*, Benjamin Fernandez* <i>US Patent App. 18/516,898. 2024.</i>	*Equal Contributions

WORKING PAPERS

The Illusion of Collusion: How Experimentation Algorithm Choice Affects Naive Algorithmic Collusion

Connor Douglas, Foster Provost, Arun Sundararajan

Working Paper

Logging Policy Design for Efficient Off-policy Evaluation

Connor Douglas, Joel Persson, Foster Provost

In preparation, Management Science

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Experimentation in Natural Language for Efficient Estimation and Discovery

Connor Douglas

PRIMARY TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Data Science for Business (Undergraduate)

January 2025

Instructor (Overall evaluation: 4.73/5; 100% response rate, n=22)

New York University — Stern School of Business

Microeconomics (Undergraduate)

Fall 2024

Recitation Instructor

New York University — Stern School of Business

ADDITIONAL TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Intro. to Analytics and AI (Graduate)

Summer 2024, Summer 2025, Summer 2026

Teaching Fellow

New York University — Stern School of Business

Data Science for Business (Graduate)

Spring 2024

Teaching Fellow

New York University — Stern School of Business

Intro. to Econometrics (Undergraduate)

Spring 2022

Teaching Assistant

Washington University in St. Louis — Economics Department

Data Structures & Algorithms (Undergraduate)

Fall 2019, Spring 2020

Teaching Assistant

Washington University in St. Louis — Computer Science Department

INSTITUTIONAL SERVICE

ACM EC

2026

Reviewer

International Conference on Information Systems

2025

Reviewer

Info. Sys. Presentations Over the Cloud (ISPOC)

2024-2026

Organizer

Tau Beta Pi (WUSTL Chapter)

2021-2022

President

Engineers Without Borders (WUSTL Chapter)

2019-2021

Treasurer

PRESENTATIONS AND INVITED TALKS

ACM EC Workshop on Online Learning in Economics: The Illusion of Collusion. 2025.

International Conference on Information Systems : Naive Algorithmic Collusion. 2024.

Topics in Data Science Ph.D. Course: Guest lecture on multi-armed bandits and reinforcement learning. 2023, 2024.

FLAIRS 36 Conference: Oral presentation on *Computing an Optimal Strategy in a Baseball At-bat*. 2023.

GRANTS AND AWARDS

United Nation Secretary-General Award: For leading development of new data modeling methodologies, enabling novel insights on misinformation spread in peacekeeping settings (project titled “From Airwaves to Algorithms”)

NSF GRFP: Award won in Economics (2024); Total Funding: \$159,000

National Merit Scholarship: Scholarship awarded by Pfizer (2018); Total Funding: \$12,000

SELECTED GRADUATE COURSEWORK

Advanced Topics in Data Driven Decision Making (Bandit Learning), No-regret Learning in Games, Machine Learning and Sequential Decision Making, Stochastic Processes, Topics in Data Science, Topics in Digital Economics, Technical Foundations of Computation Theory, Real Analysis, Convex Optimization, Reinforcement Learning, Human-in-the-loop Computation